

PRD: Facts-Only Mutual Fund FAQ Assistant (Groww × HDFC MF)

Oct 2, 2026 · @Neha

Summary

We will ship an in-app assistant that answers factual questions about five HDFC Mutual Fund schemes (Direct Plan – Growth) in three sentences or fewer, with exactly one official source link and a freshness date. It refuses advice, performance and personal-data requests by design, so it reduces support load without creating SEBI advice risk.

Assumptions made where the brief was open:

- "Every answer" includes refusals; they follow the same template (≤ 3 sentences, one link, freshness line).
- The source link line and the "Last updated" line do not count toward the 3-sentence limit.
- "Last updated from sources" is the date the cited page was last ingested and verified, not today's date.
- v1 is English only, text only, and logged-out answers are allowed (no account context is ever used).
- Questions about NAV, AUM, fund managers or holdings are out of scope for v1, even though they are factual.

1. Problem statement and why it matters

Investors comparing schemes ask the same handful of factual questions, and the answers are scattered across scheme pages, KIMs, factsheets and TER reports. A simple question like "What is the exit load on HDFC Small Cap?" often means opening a 40-page PDF or raising a support ticket.

Support and content teams answer these repetitive questions by hand. Answers drift from the source, go stale when TERs or exit loads change, and rarely cite where the fact came from.

A generic chatbot would make this worse. If it says "this fund is a good fit for you" or compares returns, Groww risks outputs being treated as investment advice under the SEBI (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013, and breaching SEBI's rules on how mutual fund performance may be presented. Collecting PAN, Aadhaar or account numbers in a chat also creates exposure under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

Why now: a narrow, cited, facts-only assistant lets us remove repetitive support load and build user trust while keeping regulatory risk close to zero.

2. Goals and non-goals

The goal is correct, cited, short factual answers; anything that looks like advice is a non-goal by design.

Goals

- Answer the 7 supported question types for the 5 in-scope schemes accurately, citing one official source.
- Refuse advice, performance and comparison-of-merit questions politely, every time, with one educational link.
- Never accept, store or echo personal identifiers.
- Give support and content teams a reusable, cited answer for repetitive MF questions.

Non-goals (v1)

- Recommending, ranking or suitability-matching schemes.
- Computing, quoting or comparing returns, CAGR, XIRR or NAV history.
- Account-specific help (holdings, transactions, SIP status, redemptions).
- Other AMCs, Regular plans, IDCW options, or schemes outside the five listed.
- Tax advice beyond stating the ELSS lock-in rule.
- Transacting (buy, SIP set-up, redeem) from within the assistant.

3. Target users and key use cases

Two groups use the same assistant: retail investors in the app, and internal support and content teams.

User	Need	Key use cases
Retail investor comparing schemes	Quick, trustworthy facts before deciding on their own	"What is the expense ratio of HDFC Flexi Cap Direct?" · "What is the exit load on HDFC Small Cap?" · "What's the riskometer level of HDFC Balanced Advantage?"
First-time ELSS investor	Understand lock-in and minimums	"How long is the lock-in on HDFC ELSS Tax Saver?" · "What is the minimum SIP amount?"
Existing investor	Find statements for tax filing	"How do I download my capital gains statement?" · "Where do I get my account statement?"
Support agent	Paste a correct, cited answer into a ticket	Same factual questions, copied with the source link
Content team	Verify facts for in-app content	Check a benchmark or exit load against the official source

Assumption: support and content teams use the same in-app experience in v1; a separate internal console is a later phase.

4. Scope

v1 covers one AMC, five schemes, one plan variant, seven question types and about 22 official pages.

AMC: HDFC Mutual Fund. **Plan variant:** Direct Plan – Growth option only.

Schemes

1. HDFC Large Cap Fund (formerly HDFC Top 100 Fund)
2. HDFC Flexi Cap Fund (formerly HDFC Equity Fund)
3. HDFC ELSS Tax Saver (formerly HDFC Tax saver)
4. HDFC Small Cap Fund
5. HDFC Balanced Advantage Fund

Supported question types: expense ratio (TER), exit load, minimum SIP amount, ELSS lock-in, riskometer level, benchmark index, and how to download account or capital-gains statements.

Corpus (~22 pages). The split below is an assumed allocation; the final list ships as the source-list deliverable.

Publisher	Document type	Pages	Answers
HDFC MF	Scheme pages (one per scheme)	5	Benchmark, riskometer, min SIP, exit load
HDFC MF	Key Information Memorandum / SID extracts	5	Exit load, min SIP, ELSS lock-in
HDFC MF	Monthly factsheet	1	Benchmark, riskometer, TER snapshot
HDFC MF	TER disclosure page	1	Expense ratio
HDFC MF	Account statement and capital-gains statement pages	2	Statement download steps
SEBI	Riskometer circular	1	What riskometer levels mean
SEBI	Investor education pages	2	Refusal links, investor rights
AMFI	Mutual Funds Sahi Hai education pages	5	Refusal links, ELSS and SIP basics

Only domains on an allowlist (HDFC MF, SEBI, AMFI / Mutual Funds Sahi Hai) can be ingested or cited. No third-party blogs, aggregators or news.

5. Functional requirements

Every message passes a PII check first, then intent classification, and only factual in-scope questions reach retrieval and generation. Each requirement below is written to be testable.

Answering

- FR-1: Answer only from retrieved corpus passages; if no passage supports the answer above the confidence threshold, say it couldn't find this in official sources and link the scheme page, never a guess.
- FR-2: Resolve the scheme name, including former names and common short forms ("HDFC Top 100", "HDFC Taxsaver"), to one of the five canonical schemes.
- FR-3: Default every answer to Direct Plan – Growth and say so when the value differs by plan (see edge cases).
- FR-4: A post-generation validator rejects any answer that contains a return figure, a recommendation verb ("should", "better", "best", "suitable"), more than 3 sentences, or a link not in the corpus. Rejected answers regenerate once, then fall back to the FR-1 "couldn't find" response.

Citing

- FR-5: Every response carries exactly one link, taken from the metadata of the chunk that supports the answer, never generated by the model.
- FR-6: Every response ends with "Last updated from sources: DD Mon YYYY", the ingest date of the cited page.
- FR-7: Citations link to the most specific page available (the scheme page or TER page, not the HDFC MF homepage).

Refusing

- FR-8: Advice, suitability and "which is better" questions get a polite refusal, an offer of the facts we can give, and one AMFI or SEBI educational link.
- FR-9: Performance and returns questions get a refusal that links the official HDFC MF factsheet; no figures are quoted.

PII handling

- FR-10: Detect PAN, Aadhaar, phone numbers, emails, OTPs and bank or folio account numbers on the client before the message is sent, using pattern checks (e.g., PAN format, 12-digit Aadhaar with checksum, 10-digit Indian mobile).
- FR-11: On detection, block the send, clear the input, and show: "For your safety, please don't share personal details like PAN, Aadhaar, account numbers or OTPs. I don't need them to answer." Offer a link to Groww's help centre for account-specific issues.
- FR-12: A server-side redaction pass is the backstop; any PII that reaches the server is masked before logging, never sent to the model, and never stored in analytics.
- FR-13: The assistant never asks for personal details and never uses account context, even for logged-in users.

Out of scope

- FR-14: Questions about other AMCs, other schemes, Regular or IDCW plans, or unsupported fields (NAV, AUM, fund manager) get a short message stating what is covered, plus one link to the relevant official HDFC MF or AMFI page.
- FR-15: Non-MF questions (stocks, loans, general chat) get a one-line redirect to Groww help, with no link to a third party.

6. Intent classification rules

Intents are checked in a fixed precedence order: PII, then advice, then performance, then out-of-scope, then fact. A message is answered as a fact only if no earlier rule fires; when unsure between fact and advice, the classifier must choose advice.

Precedence	Intent	Rule	Example queries	Response
1	PII	Message contains a PAN, Aadhaar, phone, email, OTP or account/folio number pattern	"My PAN is ABCDE1234F, show my ELSS lock-in date" · "OTP is 482913, why isn't my statement coming?"	Block send, safety message, help-centre link (FR-10 to FR-13)
2	Advice	Asks what to buy, sell, hold, switch, or which is better/suitable, or mentions own portfolio or goals	"Should I buy HDFC Small Cap now?" · "Which is better for me, Flexi Cap or Large Cap?"	Polite refusal + one AMFI or SEBI education link
3	Performance	Asks about returns, CAGR, NAV growth, rankings, or past/future performance	"What were HDFC Flexi Cap's 5-year returns?" · "Has Balanced Advantage beaten its benchmark?"	Refusal + link to the official HDFC MF factsheet

Precedence	Intent	Rule	Example queries	Response
4	Out-of-scope	Other AMC, scheme, plan or option; unsupported field; non-MF topic	"What's the exit load on SBI Small Cap?" · "Who manages HDFC Large Cap Fund?"	State what is covered + one official link
5	Fact	One of the 7 supported question types for an in-scope scheme	"What is the expense ratio of HDFC ELSS Tax Saver Direct Growth?" · "How do I download my capital gains statement from HDFC MF?"	≤ 3-sentence answer + one source link + freshness line

Mixed messages follow the highest-precedence intent. For example, "What's the exit load and should I exit now?" is handled as advice, and the refusal offers to share the exit load as a separate question, so each response keeps a single link.

7. Answer format and tone guidelines

Every response, answer or refusal, uses one fixed template: up to 3 sentences, one source line, one freshness line.

Template

1. Body: 1–3 sentences. The first sentence states the fact with the full scheme name and plan.
2. Source: one link with a readable label, e.g. "Source: HDFC Small Cap Fund – scheme page".
3. Freshness: "Last updated from sources: DD Mon YYYY".

Tone

- Neutral, plain English, written for a first-time investor; define a term in a few words if needed ("exit load, a fee for redeeming early").
- Numbers with units and conditions: "1% if redeemed within 1 year", "0.xx% per year".
- No hype or judgement words: best, safe, good, ideal, recommended, guaranteed.

- No first-person opinions ("I think", "I'd suggest"); no emoji; no urgency.
- Refusals are warm and brief, never lecture, and always offer what we can answer.

Sample answer (illustrative; link and date are placeholders)

Q: How long is the lock-in for HDFC ELSS Tax Saver?

HDFC ELSS Tax Saver (Direct Plan – Growth) has a 3-year lock-in from the date units are allotted. For SIPs, each instalment is locked in for 3 years from its own allotment date, so units unlock in stages. These units cannot be redeemed or switched out before their lock-in ends.

Source: HDFC ELSS Tax Saver – scheme page ([hdfcfund.com](#))

Last updated from sources: 28 Sep 2026

Sample refusal (illustrative)

Q: Which is better for me, HDFC Flexi Cap or HDFC Large Cap?

I can share facts about these schemes, but I can't recommend which one suits you. I can tell you either fund's expense ratio, exit load, riskometer level or benchmark if that helps. To learn how to choose a fund for your goals, see AMFI's investor education page.

Source: Mutual Funds Sahi Hai – investor education ([mutualfundssahihai.com](#))

Last updated from sources: 28 Sep 2026

8. Edge cases

Each edge case has a defined behaviour so engineering and QA can test it directly.

Edge case	Example	Expected behaviour
Scheme renames	"Exit load on HDFC Top 100?"	Map the former name to HDFC Large Cap Fund via an alias table; answer under the current name and mention the former name once ("HDFC Large Cap Fund, formerly HDFC Top 100 Fund..."). Same for HDFC Equity Fund and HDFC Tax saver.
Direct vs Regular ambiguity	"What's the expense ratio of HDFC Flexi Cap?"	Answer for Direct Plan – Growth and label it. For fields that differ by plan (TER), add: "Regular Plan values differ; see the linked page." Questions explicitly about Regular or IDCW are out of scope.
Stale data	TER changed after last ingest	Re-ingest TER and scheme pages weekly and factsheets on publication. If the cited page is older than its freshness limit (TER 7 days, factsheet 35 days, KIM 180 days), add "Please check the linked page for the latest value" as one of the 3 sentences. If a page fails to fetch, keep the last good version and alert the owner.
Factual comparison	"Exit loads of Small Cap vs Flexi Cap?"	Allowed only if one official page supports both facts (e.g., the factsheet or TER page); otherwise answer for the first scheme and invite a second question. Never say which is lower is "better".
Merit comparison	"Which has lower risk, so should I pick it?"	Treated as advice: refusal + education link.

Edge case	Example	Expected behaviour
Scheme not in corpus	"HDFC Mid Cap Opportunities exit load?"	State the five covered schemes and link the HDFC MF schemes listing page; never answer from model memory.
Partial or misspelled names	"hdfc smallcap", "BAF"	Fuzzy-match to the canonical scheme if confidence is high; if two schemes match, ask the user to pick from chips.
Conflicting sources	Scheme page and factsheet disagree	Prefer the most recent document by date; log the conflict for content review.
Statement download	"How do I get my CAS?"	Give the steps from the HDFC MF statement page, linking it; never offer to fetch or email the statement.

9. UI requirements

The assistant opens as a bottom sheet from each in-scope scheme page and from Help, with a persistent disclaimer and three tappable example questions.

- **Entry points:** an "Ask about this fund" button on the five scheme pages (pre-fills the scheme) and a link in the Help centre.
- **Welcome line:** "Hi! Ask me facts about 5 HDFC Mutual Fund schemes – expense ratio, exit load, SIP minimums, lock-in, riskometer, benchmark or statements."
- **Example questions (3 chips):** "What is the exit load on HDFC Small Cap Fund?" · "How long is the HDFC ELSS Tax Saver lock-in?" · "How do I download my capital gains statement?"
- **Disclaimer:** "Facts-only. No investment advice." shown pinned under the header, always visible, never dismissible.
- **Input hint:** "Ask a factual question. Don't share PAN, Aadhaar or account details."
- **Answer bubble:** body text, then the source as a tappable label that opens in the in-app browser, then the freshness line in secondary text.
- **PII block state:** inline warning above the input, the input cleared, nothing sent.

- **Feedback:** thumbs up/down on each answer, with an optional reason ("wrong", "outdated", "not helpful").
- **No transaction CTAs** (Invest, Start SIP) inside the assistant, so answers are never framed as a nudge to act.
- **Accessibility:** screen-reader labels on chips and links; text scales with system font size.

10. Success metrics

Launch is gated on a golden set of 200 labelled queries (about 120 fact, 30 advice, 20 performance, 15 out-of-scope, 15 PII), re-run on every corpus or prompt change.

Metric	Definition	Launch target	How measured
Factual accuracy	Fact answers whose value matches the cited source exactly	≥ 95%	Golden set, human-graded
Citation correctness	Answers whose single link is allowlisted and contains the stated fact	≥ 98%	Golden set + automated link check
Refusal recall	Advice/performance queries correctly refused	≥ 99%	Golden set + weekly red-team set
Refusal precision	Refusals that were truly advice/performance (not over-refusing facts)	≥ 90%	Golden set
Length and format compliance	Responses with ≤ 3 sentences, exactly 1 link, freshness line	100%	Automated validator on all production traffic
PII leakage	PII values found in logs, prompts or analytics	0	Daily log scan
Fabricated facts	Answers with no supporting passage	0 in golden set	Groundedness check
Helpfulness	Thumbs-up rate on answers	≥ 80%	In-app feedback

Metric	Definition	Launch target	How measured
Support deflection	Drop in tickets on the 7 question types for these schemes	20% in 90 days	Support ticket tagging

Refusal recall is set higher than precision on purpose: a missed advice question is a regulatory risk, while an over-refusal only costs convenience.

11. Known limitations and risks

The biggest risks are an advice-like answer slipping through and a stale number being shown as current; both have layered controls.

Risk or limitation	Impact	Mitigation
Advice-like phrasing slips past the classifier	Regulatory exposure	Classifier biased to advice when unsure; post-generation banned-phrase validator; compliance review of samples before launch and monthly
Stale TER or exit load shown	Wrong fact, user trust	Freshness limits and re-ingest schedule (section 8); freshness date on every answer
Retrieval picks the wrong scheme's chunk	Wrong fact with a real citation	Chunk metadata filtered by resolved scheme before ranking; accuracy tests per scheme
PDF parsing errors on KIM and factsheet tables	Wrong numbers	Manual verification of extracted values for all 5 schemes at each ingest
PII patterns miss unusual formats	Personal data reaches server	Server-side redaction backstop; no raw message storage
3-sentence limit cuts nuance (e.g., tiered exit loads)	Incomplete answer	Link always points to the full condition; templates for common multi-tier loads

Risk or limitation	Impact	Mitigation
Narrow scope frustrates users	Low engagement	Clear welcome copy on coverage; out-of-scope answers name what is covered; scope expansion in a later phase
Official URLs change	Broken links	Weekly link-health check; alert on 4xx/5xx

Out of v1: Hindi and other languages, voice, Regular and IDCW plans, other AMCs, and account-specific answers.

12. Deliverables checklist

The release is complete when all six items below are reviewed by Product, Engineering and Compliance.

- ☐ **Working prototype:** RAG pipeline with PII pre-check, intent classifier, retrieval over the ~22-page corpus, generation, and the format validator, embedded in a Groww app build.
- ☐ **Source list:** every corpus URL with publisher, document type, scheme, question types it answers, freshness limit and last ingest date.
- ☐ **README:** architecture, setup, how to re-ingest sources, how to add a scheme alias, how to run the golden-set evaluation, and known limitations.
- ☐ **Sample Q&A:** at least 2 examples per intent (section 6), plus every edge case in section 8, with expected responses.
- ☐ **Disclaimer:** "Facts-only. No investment advice." pinned in the UI, with copy signed off by Compliance.
- ☐ **Evaluation report:** golden-set results against every launch target in section 10.